

5.3

Types of business document

Worksheet

A Match each document type on the left with a definition on the right.

- | | |
|----------------------|---|
| 1 an enquiry | a a request to supply goods (sent by the customer) |
| 2 a quotation | b a request for information (sent by the customer) |
| 3 an estimate | c an approximate calculation of the cost of something |
| 4 a counter-proposal | d the price given for goods or a piece of work |
| 5 an order | e a letter where the customer tries to get better terms |
| 6 an invoice | f a document that proves you have paid for some goods |
| 7 a reminder | g a list of amounts paid and still owed, sent every month |
| 8 a receipt | h a bill for goods sent or work done |
| 9 a statement | i a letter to a customer about an unpaid invoice |
| 10 a complaint | j a letter saying you are not satisfied about something |

B Complete the sequence 1–15 with the business documents in the box.

**Enquiry Complaint Counter-proposal Order, with a covering letter Receipt
Quotation Statement Reply to an enquiry Reminder Reply to a complaint**

- | Customer sends | Supplier sends |
|---------------------------|--|
| 1 | 2 |
| 3 Request for a quotation | 4 |
| 5 | 6 Reply to a counter-proposal |
| 7 | |
| | <i>Goods are dispatched</i> |
| | 8 Invoice |
| | <i>Goods arrive, but there is a problem</i> |
| 9 | 10 |
| | <i>The problem is solved</i> |
| | 11 |
| 12 Payment | 13 |
| | <i>The customer starts to place regular orders</i> |
| | 14 |
| 15 Further payments | |

C In which documents from section B would you find the following sentences?

- I am afraid your minimum quantity is too high for our first order. Please let us know if you are able to reduce this.
- When we opened the package we noticed that some of the goods were damaged.
- We saw your advert in a recent issue of *Engineering* magazine. We are interested in ...
- Unfortunately it is not possible to reduce the delivery time, but we could offer a discount of 2% for an order of this size.
- Thank you for your letter of 21 April asking about We are pleased to enclose our current brochure and price list.
- We apologize for sending the wrong parts. This was due to a computer error in our packing department.
- Please find enclosed our order for Our bankers will be pleased to provide references.
- We note from our records that your account for the first quarter is still not paid. We hope to receive payment of this account as soon as possible.